

Wheeled Troop Carriers

Wheeled personnel carriers remained in widespread use throughout the Cold War. They often shared automotive components with their more heavily armed counterparts, which made them easier and cheaper to build. However, few of them had the armor or firepower to operate on the front line. For this reason, some countries, such as the Soviet Union, West Germany, and the UK, split their fleets, equipping front-line forces with tracked infantry fighting vehicles (IFVs), and restricting wheeled vehicles to units tasked as reinforcements or for defensive operations.

▽ **BTR-152**

Date	1950	Country	Soviet Union
Weight	11.1 tons (10.1 tonnes)		
Engine	ZIS-123 gasoline, 110 hp		
Main armament	7.62 mm SGMB machine gun		

Larger and more mobile than the BTR-40, the BTR-152 could carry 15 infantrymen. Later models had an armored roof and the first Soviet central tire pressure regulation system. Over 12,500 BTR-152s of all variants were built, and saw decades of service around the world.

Soviet insignia



Armored door to driver's compartment

Sloped front armor



△ **BTR-40**

Date	1950	Country	Soviet Union
Weight	5.8 tons (5.3 tonnes)		
Engine	GAZ-40 gasoline, 80 hp		
Main armament	7.62 mm SGMB machine gun		

The first Soviet APC, the BTR-40 was a four-wheel drive, open-topped vehicle based on a light truck. It could carry eight infantrymen, or six in the later BTR-40B variant that had an armored roof. Sold around the world, it saw combat in Korea, Hungary, Vietnam, and the Middle East.

▽ **FV603 Saracen**

Date	1952	Country	UK
Weight	11.2 tons (10.2 tonnes)		
Engine	Rolls-Royce B80 Mk 6A gasoline, 160 hp		
Main armament	.30 Browning M1919 machine gun		

The British Army's standard APC during the 1950s, the Saracen had a drivetrain that gave excellent mobility. It had a capacity for 10 infantrymen, and its variants included a command vehicle, an ambulance, and an internal security version for use in Northern Ireland.

Driver's vision port

